Uri Berger

Postdoctoral researcher, NLP, Computer Science
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Education

- **The Hebrew University of Jerusalem – University of Melbourne** 2021 - 2026
  Joint Ph.D - Computer Science
  Thesis title: Human-Inspired Multimodal Language Modeling
  Advisors: Omri Abend, Gabriel Stanovsky, Lea Frermann

- **The Hebrew University of Jerusalem** 2018 - 2021
  M.Sc. - Computer Science; GPA: 97.57 (magna cum laude)
  Thesis title: Competition-based Spiking Neural Networks
  Advisor: Prof. Ari Rappoport

- **Tel-Aviv University** 2013 - 2017
  B.Sc. - Computer Science; GPA: 96 (summa cum laude)

Work Experience

- **NVIDIA** 2026
  Deep Learning Research Intern
  Improving vision-and-language reasoning models

- **Amazon** 2025 - 2026
  Applied Science Intern (Part-time)
  Aligning video comparison to human preferences, improving diversity in LLMs

- **The Hebrew University of Jerusalem** 2023 - 2025
  Teaching Assistant (Part-time)
  Course name: *Advanced Natural Language Processing*

- **IBM** 2022
  Research Intern (Summer Internship)
  Improving factuality in Data-to-Text models

- **The Hebrew University of Jerusalem** 2020 - 2022
  Teaching Assistant (Part-time)
  Course name: *Human Language from a Computational Perspective*

- **eBay** 2020 - 2021
  Research Intern (Part-time)
  Using NLP techniques to provide insights to sellers

- **The Hebrew University of Jerusalem** 2019
  Grader (Part-time)
  Course name: *Probabilistic Methods in Artificial Intelligence*

- **Cadence Design Systems, Inc.** 2016 - 2018
  Software Engineer (Full-time)
  Developing parsing tools for the Verilog Compiler

- **Rocketick Technologies** 2014 - 2016
  Software Engineer (Part-time)
  Developing parsing tools for the Verilog Compiler

Publications

U. Berger, G. Chechick and G. Dalal
Look Where You Say You're Looking: Self-Grounded Attention for Visual Reasoning
arXiv preprint

U. Berger, G. Stanovsky, O. Abend and L. Frermann
Surveying the Landscape of Image Captioning Evaluation: A Comprehensive Taxonomy and Novel Ensemble Method
Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics (TACL)

U. Berger, EM. Ponti
Cross-Lingual and Cross-Cultural Variation in Image Descriptions
North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL 2025)

N. Eckhaus, **U. Berger** and G. Stanovsky
Time to Talk: LLM Agents for Asynchronous Group Communication in Mafia Games
Findings of the Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2025)

U. Berger, T. Baumel and G. Stanovsky
In-Context Learning on a Budget: A Case Study in Named Entity Recognition
Workshop on Insights from Negative Results in NLP

L. Mahon, O. Abend, **U. Berger**, K. Demuth, M. Johnson and M. Steedman
A Language-agnostic Model of Child Language Acquisition
Computer Speech & Language

S. Neuberger, N. Eckhaus, **U. Berger**, A. Taubenfeld, G. Stanovsky, A. Goldstein
SAUCE: Synchronous and Asynchronous User-Customizable Environment for Multi-Agent LLM Interaction
arXiv preprint

U. Berger, O. Abend, L. Frermann and G. Stanovsky
Improving Image Captioning by Mimicking Human Reformulation Feedback at Inference-time
arXiv preprint

U. Berger, L. Frermann, G. Stanovsky and O. Abend
A Large-Scale Multilingual Study of Visual Constraints on Linguistic Selection of Descriptions
Findings of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL 2023)

U. Berger, G. Stanovsky, O. Abend, and L. Frermann
A computational acquisition model for multimodal word categorization
North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL 2022)

Awards and Scholarships

Scholarships

- The Planning and Budgeting Committee (PBD) scholarship program for outstanding data science PhD students

M.Sc.

- Graduated with distinction (magna cum laude)
- Dean's Honor

B.Sc.

- Graduated with distinction (summa cum laude)
- Dean's Honor